THE MESSY HANDS COOKING MODE

Less touching. More cooking.

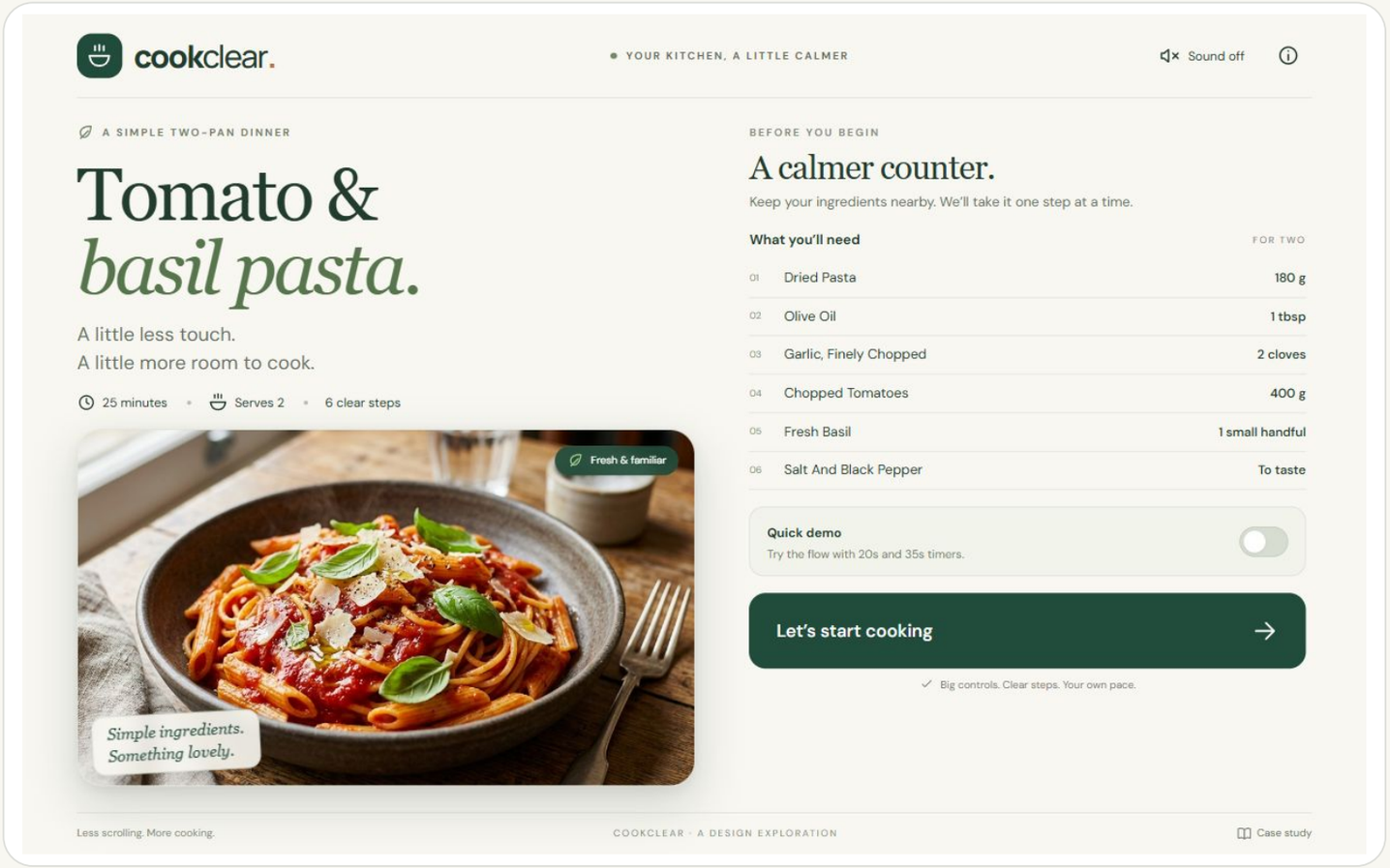
CookClear

A focused recipe workspace for occupied hands and parallel cooking tasks.

- Complete tablet + phone screen gallery
- Working public browser prototype
- Case study + documented verification

Open the live prototype

Prepared 10 October 2026



Actual browser prototype / 1280 x 800 CSS viewport

SECONDARY RESEARCH / INTERACTION DESIGN / IMPLEMENTATION

The recipe should stay with the cook.

A countertop tablet. Occupied hands. Several tasks cooking at once.

The problem

A dense recipe page asks a cook to read, scroll, find quantities, and remember which timer belongs to which task.

DESIGN HYPOTHESIS

One dominant step, generous controls, and task-labelled timers can make a recipe easier to follow.

Context is derived from the supplied assignment: a tablet viewed from 3-5 feet, occupied hands, and active timers. No participant study is included.

01 **Generous targets support coarse input.**

W3C describes 44 x 44 CSS pixel targets in its enhanced criterion, with exceptions. This informs a direction; it does not establish an elbow standard.

W3C: Target Size (Enhanced)

02 **Release and recovery reduce mistakes.**

W3C pointer-cancellation guidance supports release activation and recovery. Native buttons and a visible Previous action inform the interaction.

W3C: Pointer Cancellation

03 **Recipe timers are established functionality.**

Crouton and Paprika document cooking timers. CookClear focuses on readable task identity and continuity through step changes and interruptions.

Crouton: Official product documentation

Three constraints. One focused surface.

Every design decision traces to a requirement in the supplied brief.

01

BRIEF CONSTRAINT

View from 3-5 feet

Instruction first

Show one dominant action and its quantities. Use short lines, dark text, and subordinate supporting content.

Physical distance readability is unvalidated.

02

BRIEF CONSTRAINT

Occupied or messy hands

Generous actions + recovery

Separate Previous and Next. Use native buttons, visible focus, and a deliberate reset to support predictable recovery.

Elbow contact detection and comfort are device-dependent and unvalidated.

03

BRIEF CONSTRAINT

Multiple active timers

Persistent task identity

Keep Pasta and Sauce labelled independently. Preserve running, finished, and acknowledged states through navigation.

Software timer behavior is verified separately from physical usability.

Keep recipe progress separate from time.

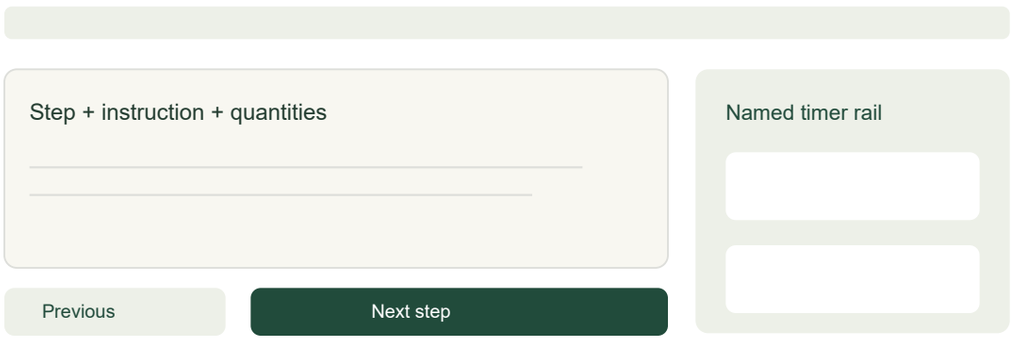
Navigation changes the instruction. It never starts or resets a timer.

01 **Review recipe** — 02 **Start cooking** — 03 **Start Pasta** — 04 **Start Sauce** — 05 **Acknowledge** — 06 **Finish steps**

RECOVERY BRANCH

Previous changes the step while timers continue. Refresh restores the saved session and reconciles deadlines. Starting a fresh session makes reset deliberate.

STRUCTURAL WIREFRAME / RECONSTRUCTED



A BOUNDED WORKING PROTOTYPE

One original illustrative recipe keeps the complete interaction reviewable. Recipe data, step/session state, and timer deadlines feed a responsive React interface.

SIMPLE PERSISTENCE

Local storage restores progress on the same browser. The prototype has no account, backend, recipe search, or cross-device sync.

A calm surface with a strong action hierarchy.

Consistent color, typography, control placement, and readable task identity.



Cream
#F8F7F1

Ink
#233C30

Green
#214B3B

Soft
#EDF0E8

Attention
#FFF0D8

One clear step.

Add **180 g** pasta. Start the **Pasta** timer.

The app combines Georgia headings with Manrope instruction text and DM Sans interface labels. This document uses embedded Georgia and Arial for dependable PDF rendering.

LANDSCAPE TABLET IS PRIMARY

A final layout refinement fits both the recipe overview and all six cooking steps to laptop and tablet landscape screens. Photos remain subordinate to instructions; navigation stays visible.

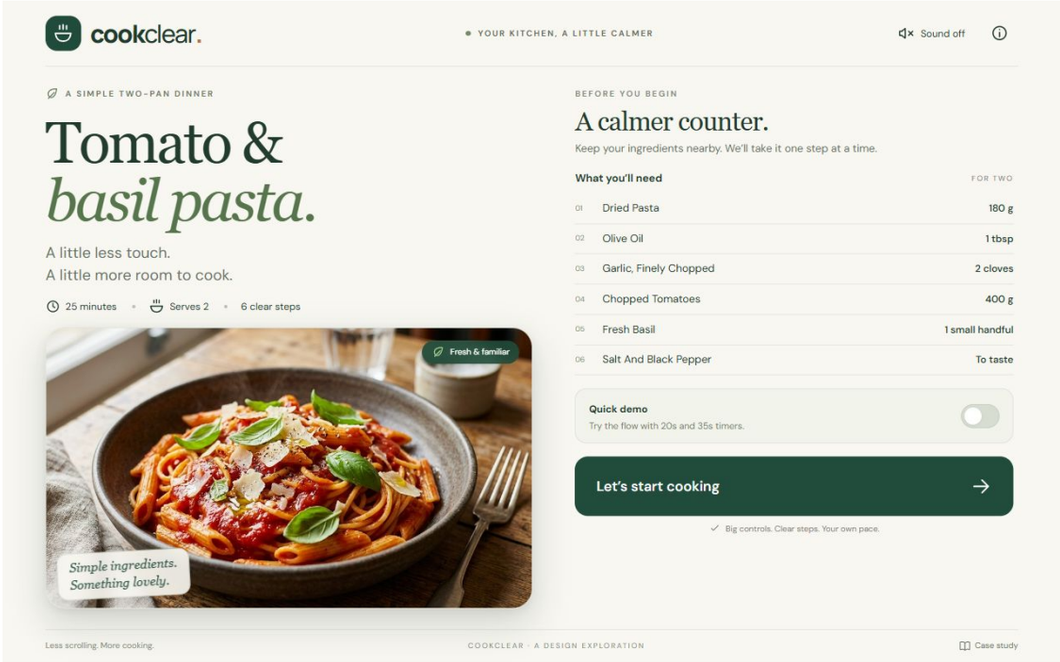
PHONE IS A VERTICAL FALLBACK

A single-column flow preserves content rather than shrinking the tablet layout. Phone pages in this PDF include an upper and lower viewport capture so that navigation and timer controls are visible.

Generous controls are a design hypothesis; real elbow usability is unvalidated.

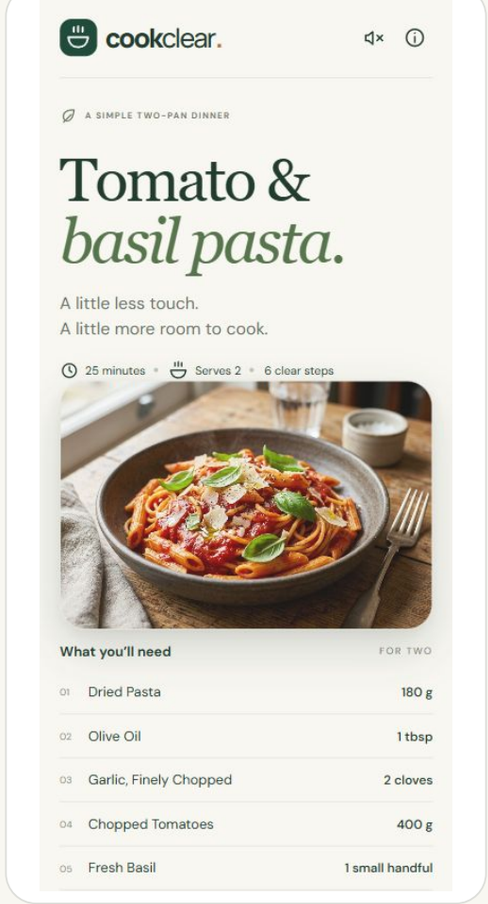
Begin with context. Then enter cooking mode.

Tablet landscape fits one screen. The phone fallback scrolls vertically; both viewport sections are shown.

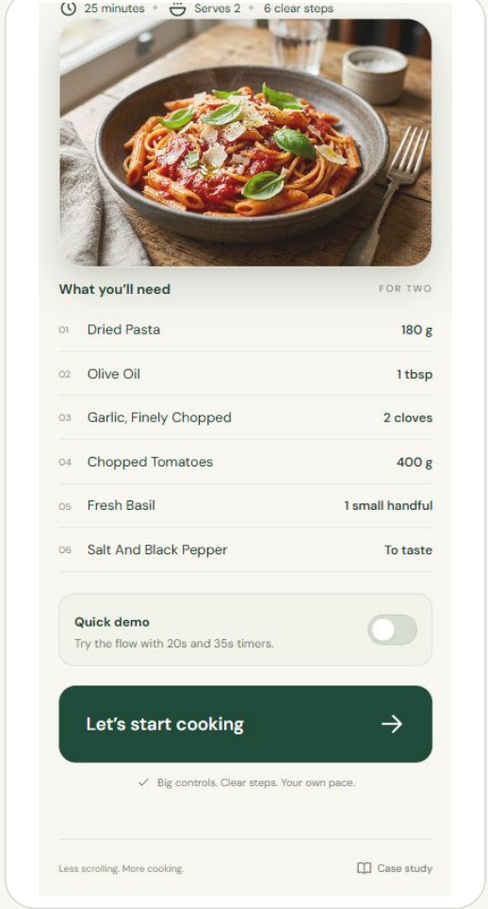


TABLET / 1280 x 800

Recipe context, ingredients, a labelled timer demo switch, and a clear Start cooking action share one landscape screen.



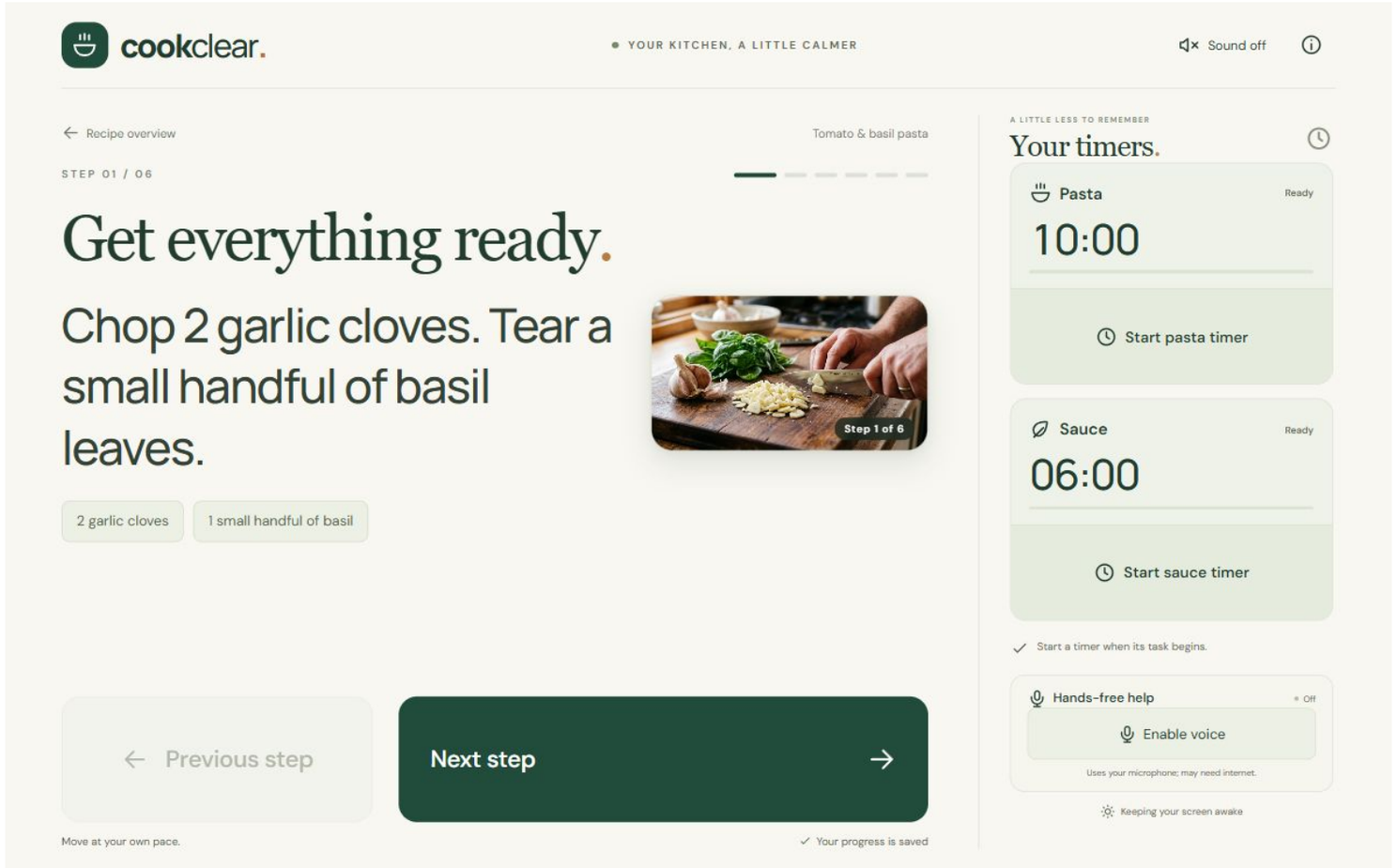
PHONE / UPPER VIEW



PHONE / LOWER VIEW

01 / Get everything ready.

Primary tablet layout: instruction, supporting image, navigation, and named timers.



NORMAL RECIPE MODE / 10m PASTA + 6m SAUCE

DESIGN DECISION

Preparation is a clear entry point. The cook sees the action and quantities together before moving to heat.

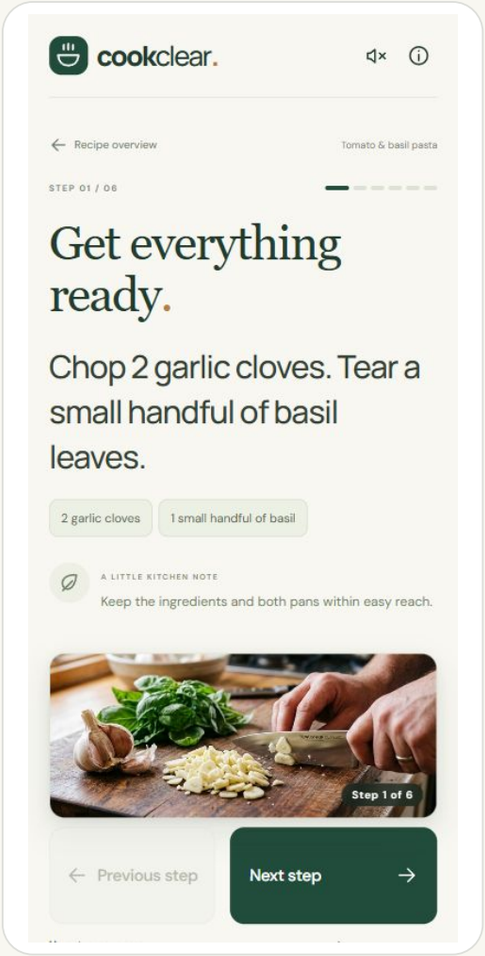
INTERACTION BEHAVIOR

The first Previous control is disabled. Forward navigation begins the recipe without starting any timer.

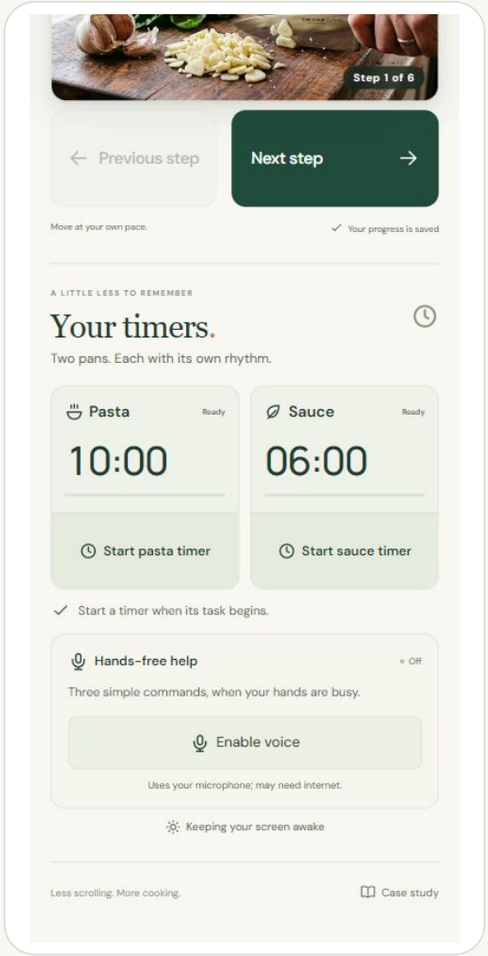
Actual browser prototype capture.
1280 x 800 CSS pixels.
Tablet landscape composition.

01 / Get everything ready.

Responsive phone fallback: upper and lower viewport captures of the same vertically scrolling page.



UPPER VIEWPORT / INSTRUCTION



LOWER VIEWPORT / TIMERS

SAME STEP. VERTICAL REFLOW.

These are two genuine viewport captures of one scrolling phone page. They are not separate screens; some content may overlap between captures.

STEP 01 / RECIPE ACTION

Chop 2 garlic cloves. Tear a small handful of basil leaves.

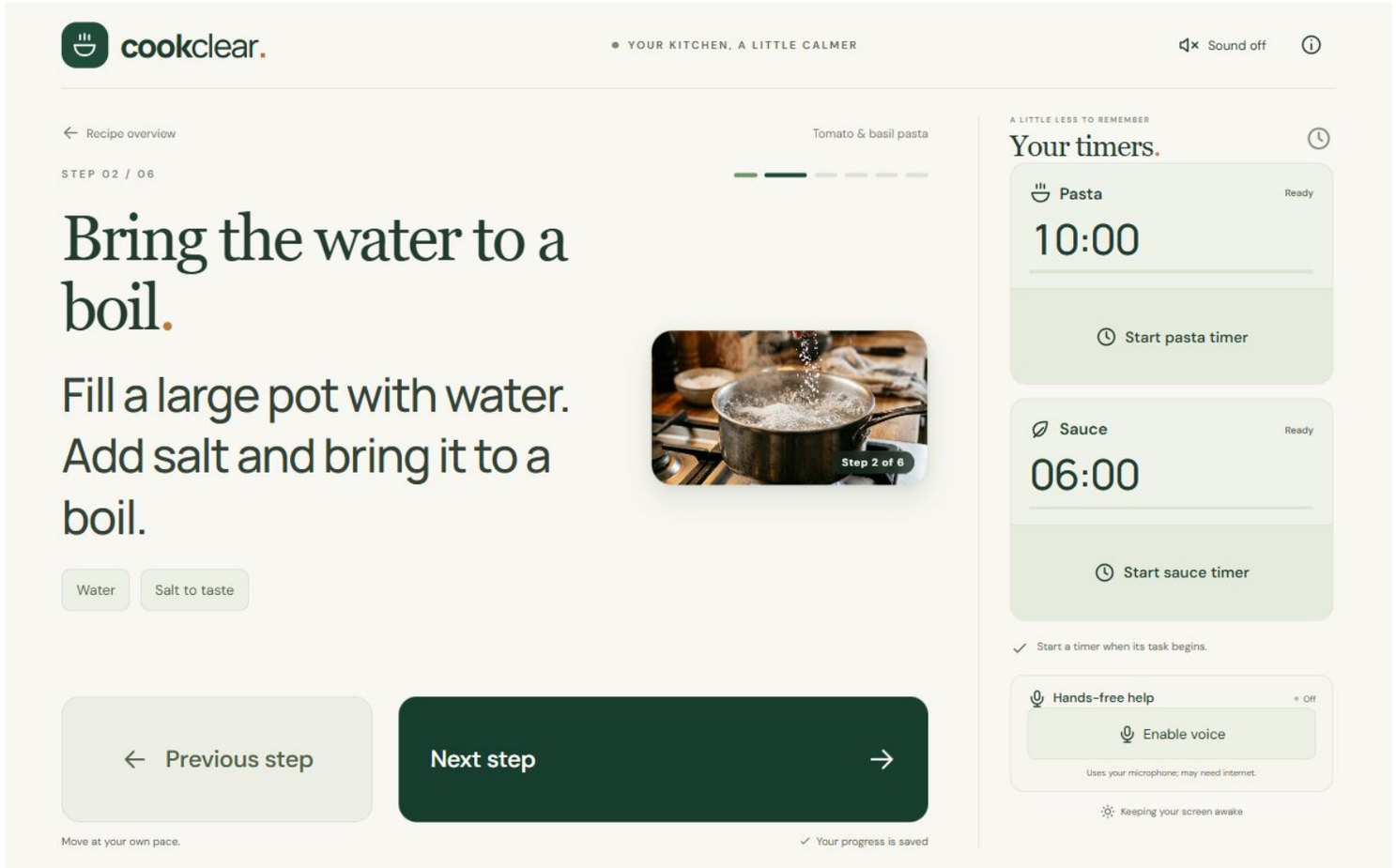
RESPONSIVE CHOICE

The content remains readable in a single column. Images support the instruction; navigation and named timers follow below. Vertical scrolling is intentional on this fallback layout.

Actual browser prototype capture / 390 x 844 CSS pixels.
The gallery documents layout; it does not claim testing on a physical phone.

02 / Bring the water to a boil.

Primary tablet layout: instruction, supporting image, navigation, and named timers.



NORMAL RECIPE MODE / 10m PASTA + 6m SAUCE

DESIGN DECISION

A single physical task leads the screen. The timer rail stays present, ready for the next cooking stage.

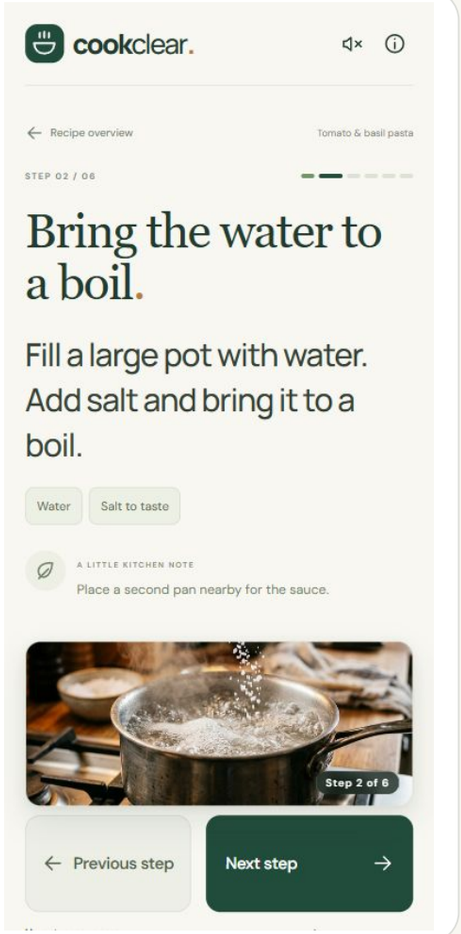
INTERACTION BEHAVIOR

A second pan can be prepared while the water heats. Previous returns to preparation without changing timer state.

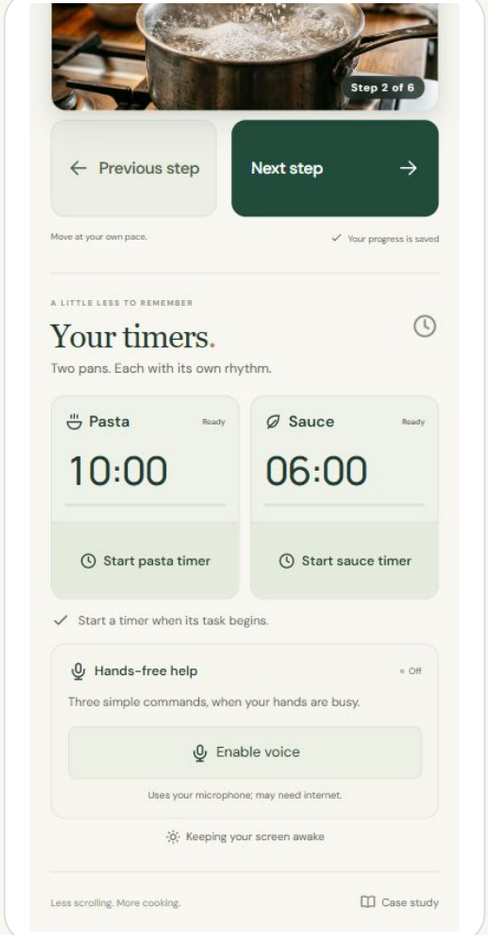
Actual browser prototype capture.
1280 x 800 CSS pixels.
Tablet landscape composition.

02 / Bring the water to a boil.

Responsive phone fallback: upper and lower viewport captures of the same vertically scrolling page.



UPPER VIEWPORT / INSTRUCTION



LOWER VIEWPORT / TIMERS

SAME STEP. VERTICAL REFLOW.

These are two genuine viewport captures of one scrolling phone page. They are not separate screens; some content may overlap between captures.

STEP 02 / RECIPE ACTION

Fill a large pot with water. Add salt and bring it to a boil.

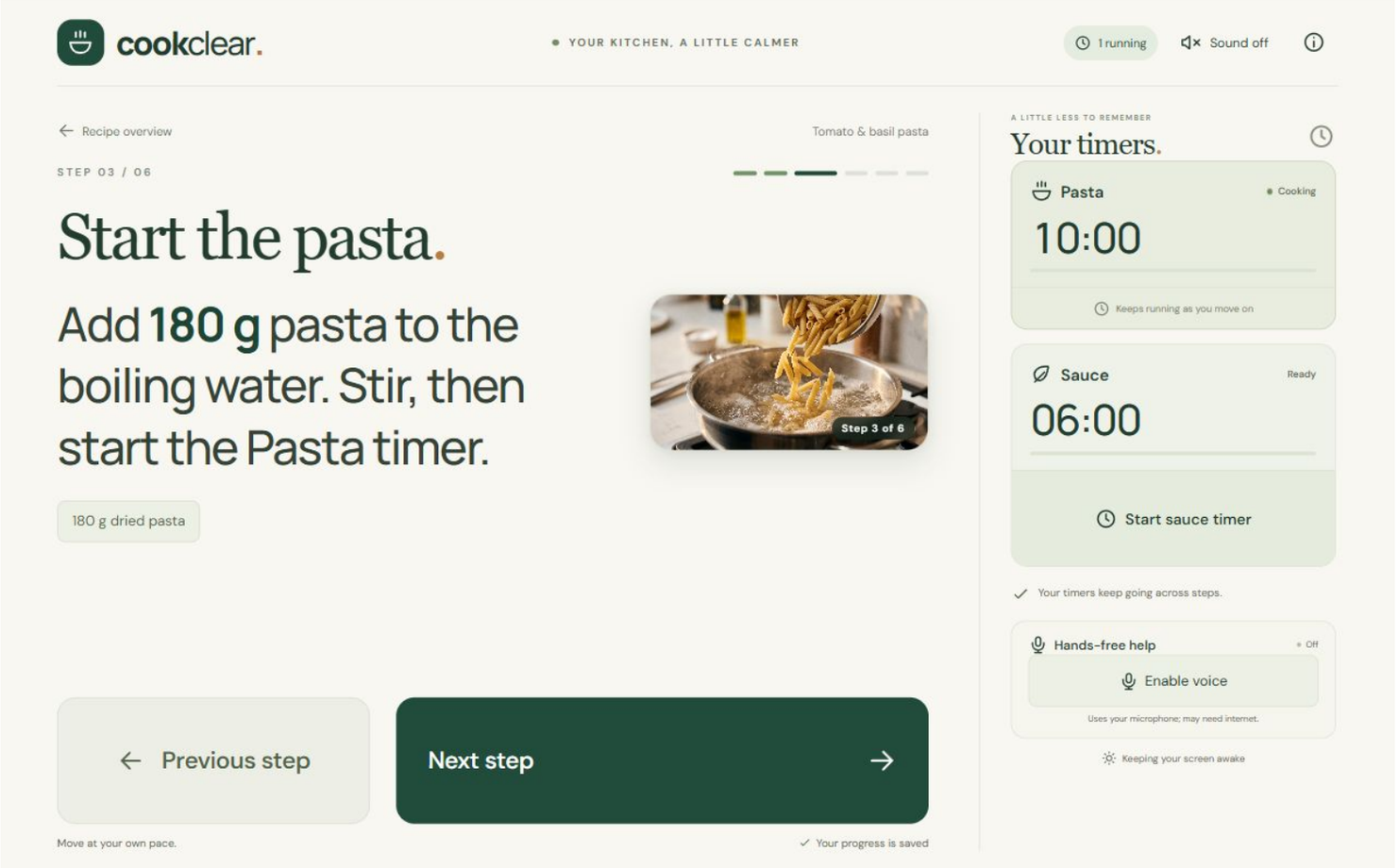
RESPONSIVE CHOICE

The content remains readable in a single column. Images support the instruction; navigation and named timers follow below. Vertical scrolling is intentional on this fallback layout.

Actual browser prototype capture / 390 x 844 CSS pixels.
The gallery documents layout; it does not claim testing on a physical phone.

03 / Start the pasta.

Primary tablet layout: instruction, supporting image, navigation, and named timers.



NORMAL RECIPE MODE / 10m PASTA + 6m SAUCE

DESIGN DECISION

The instruction explicitly names the timer. Starting it remains a deliberate action, separate from moving to another step.

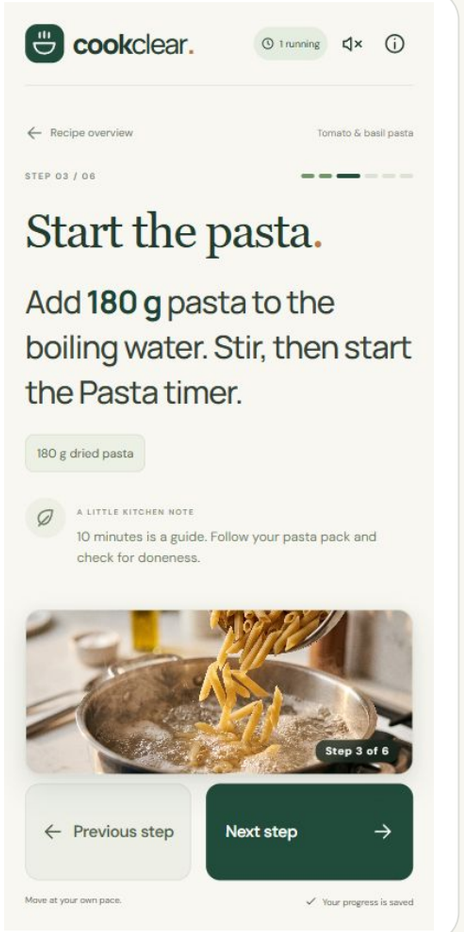
INTERACTION BEHAVIOR

The normal Pasta timer is 10 minutes. It is a guide; the recipe asks the cook to check the packet and doneness.

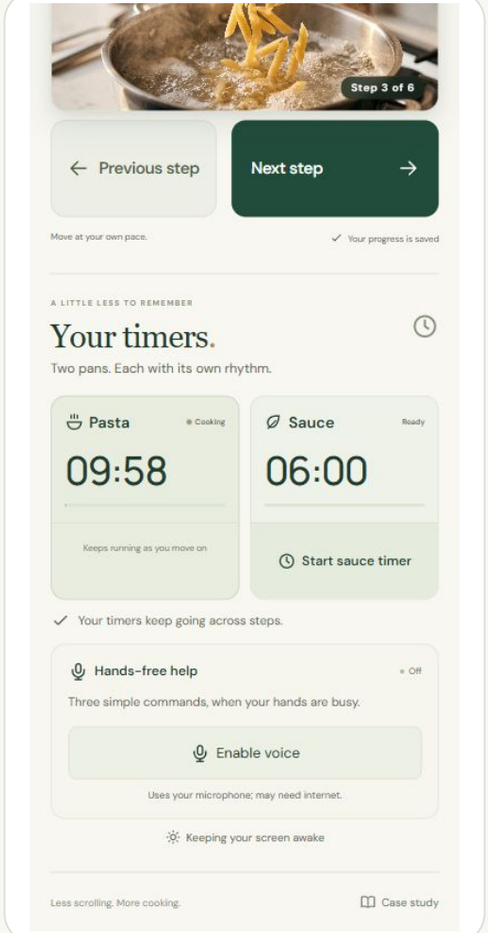
Actual browser prototype capture.
1280 x 800 CSS pixels.
Tablet landscape composition.

03 / Start the pasta.

Responsive phone fallback: upper and lower viewport captures of the same vertically scrolling page.



UPPER VIEWPORT / INSTRUCTION



LOWER VIEWPORT / TIMERS

SAME STEP. VERTICAL REFLOW.

These are two genuine viewport captures of one scrolling phone page. They are not separate screens; some content may overlap between captures.

STEP 03 / RECIPE ACTION

Add 180 g pasta to the boiling water. Stir, then start the Pasta timer.

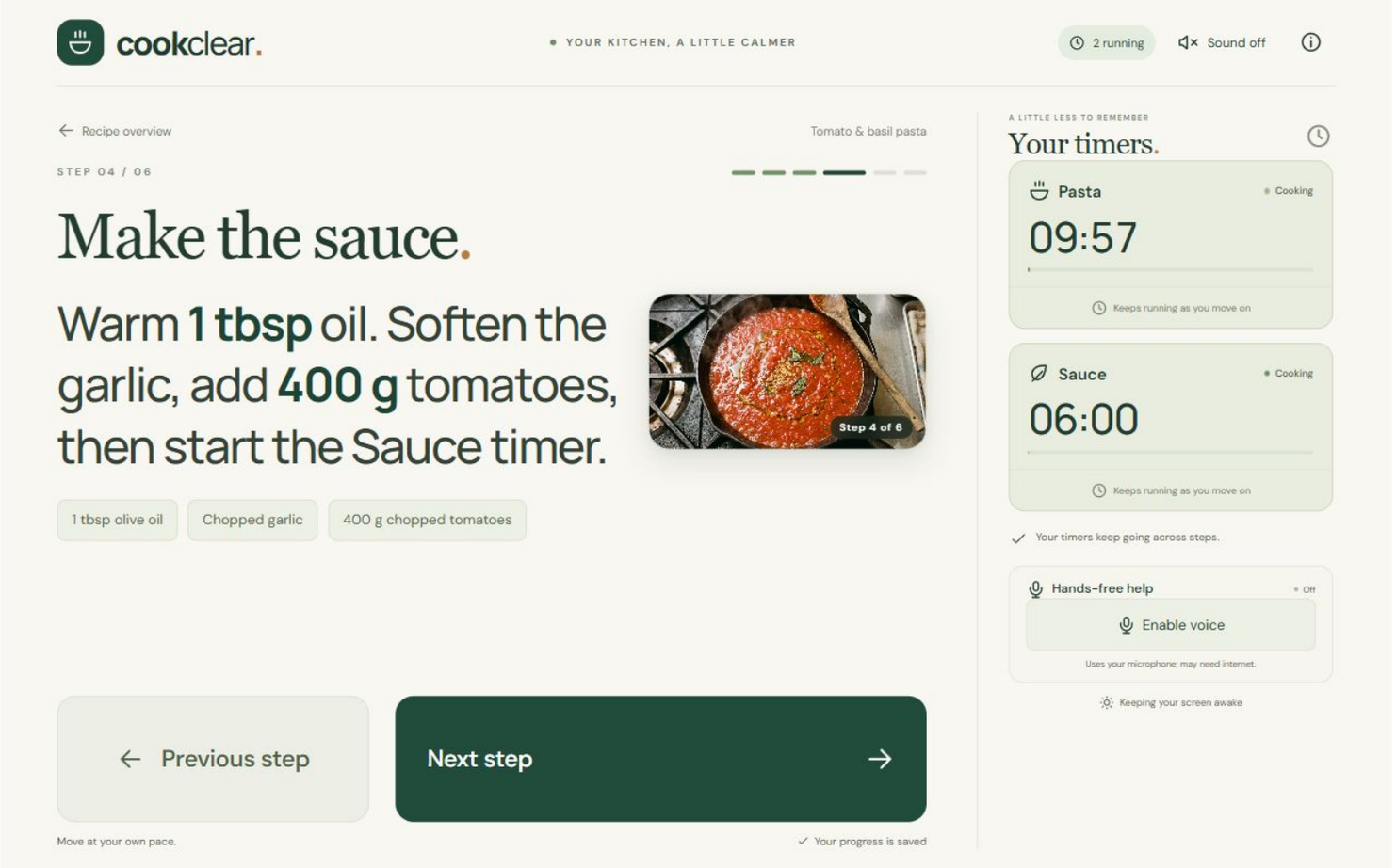
RESPONSIVE CHOICE

The content remains readable in a single column. Images support the instruction; navigation and named timers follow below. Vertical scrolling is intentional on this fallback layout.

Actual browser prototype capture / 390 x 844 CSS pixels.
The gallery documents layout; it does not claim testing on a physical phone.

04 / Make the sauce.

Primary tablet layout: instruction, supporting image, navigation, and named timers.



NORMAL RECIPE MODE / 10m PASTA + 6m SAUCE

DESIGN DECISION

Quantities appear inside the action, with bold number-unit pairs kept together. Both timer identities remain visible.

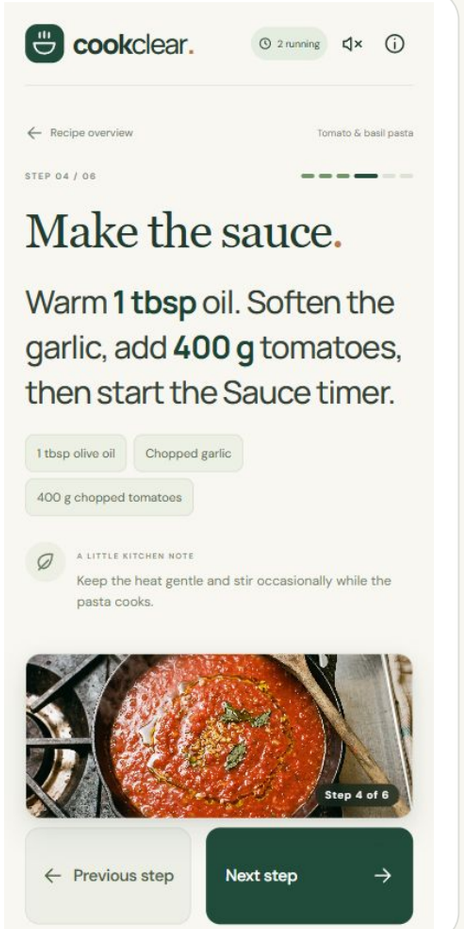
INTERACTION BEHAVIOR

The normal Sauce timer is 6 minutes. Starting Sauce does not reset or stop an already running Pasta timer.

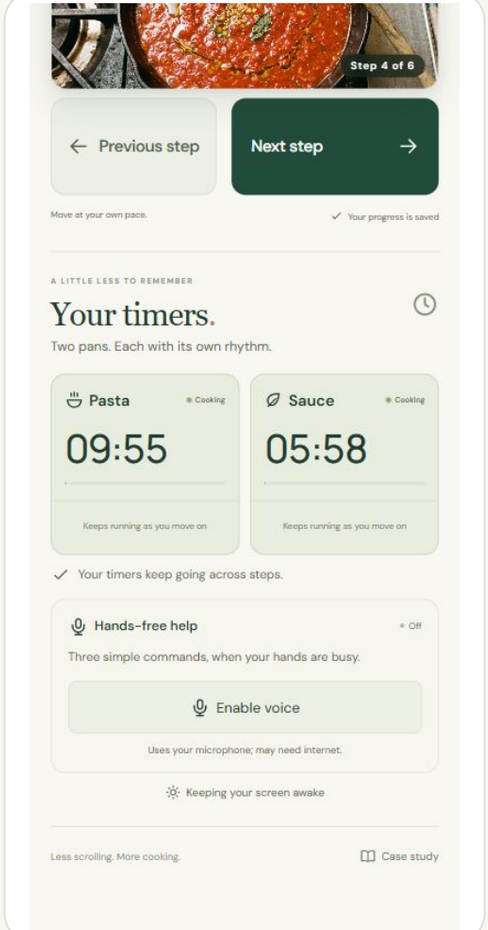
Actual browser prototype capture.
1280 x 800 CSS pixels.
Tablet landscape composition.

04 / Make the sauce.

Responsive phone fallback: upper and lower viewport captures of the same vertically scrolling page.



UPPER VIEWPORT / INSTRUCTION



LOWER VIEWPORT / TIMERS

SAME STEP. VERTICAL REFLOW.

These are two genuine viewport captures of one scrolling phone page. They are not separate screens; some content may overlap between captures.

STEP 04 / RECIPE ACTION

Warm 1 tbsp oil. Soften the garlic, add 400 g tomatoes, then start the Sauce timer.

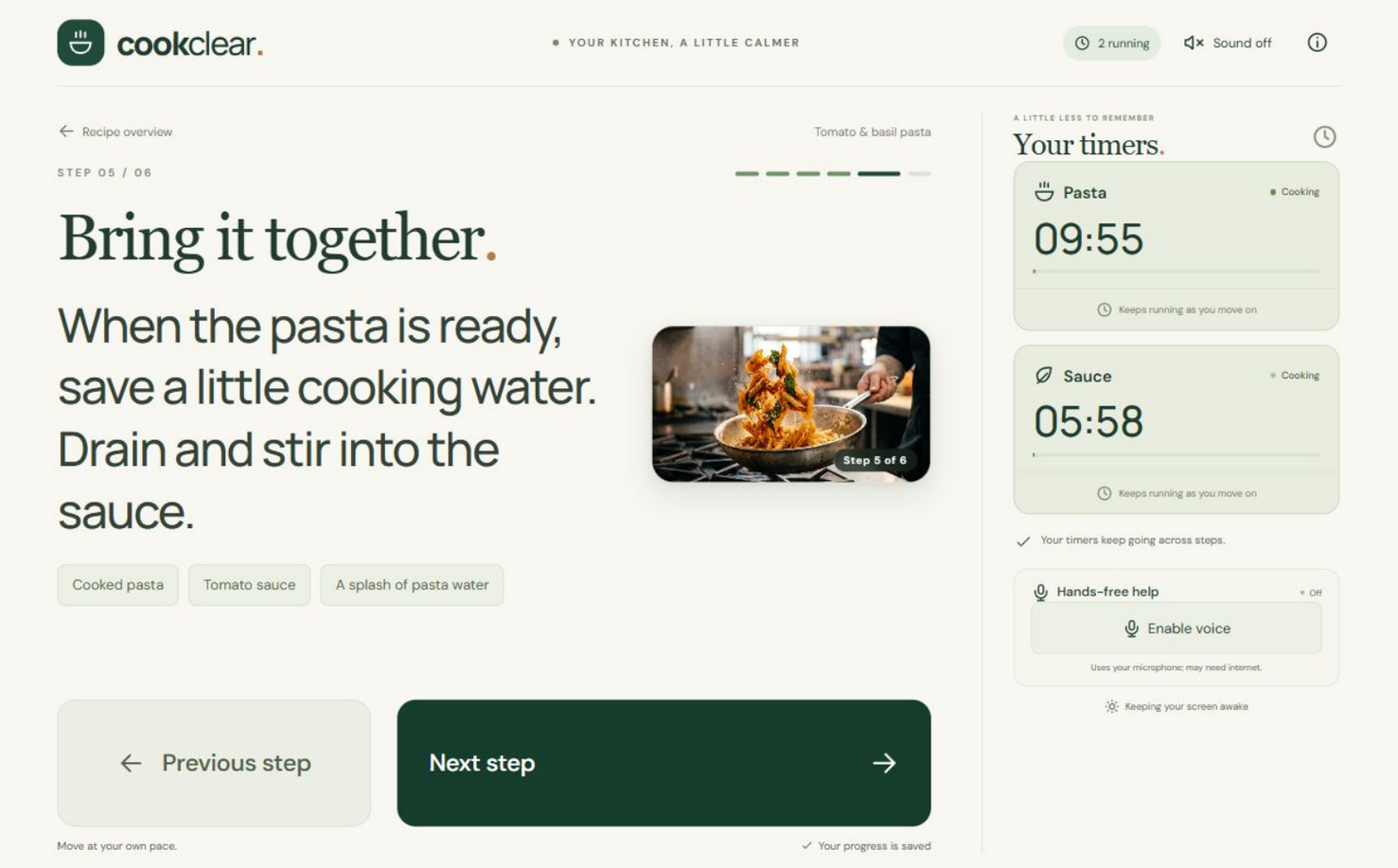
RESPONSIVE CHOICE

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Actual browser prototype capture / 390 x 844 CSS pixels.
The gallery documents layout; it does not claim testing on a physical phone.

05 / Bring it together.

Primary tablet layout: instruction, supporting image, navigation, and named timers.



NORMAL RECIPE MODE / 10m PASTA + 6m SAUCE

DESIGN DECISION

The combining instruction reconnects the two parallel tasks. Time and recipe progress remain separate states.

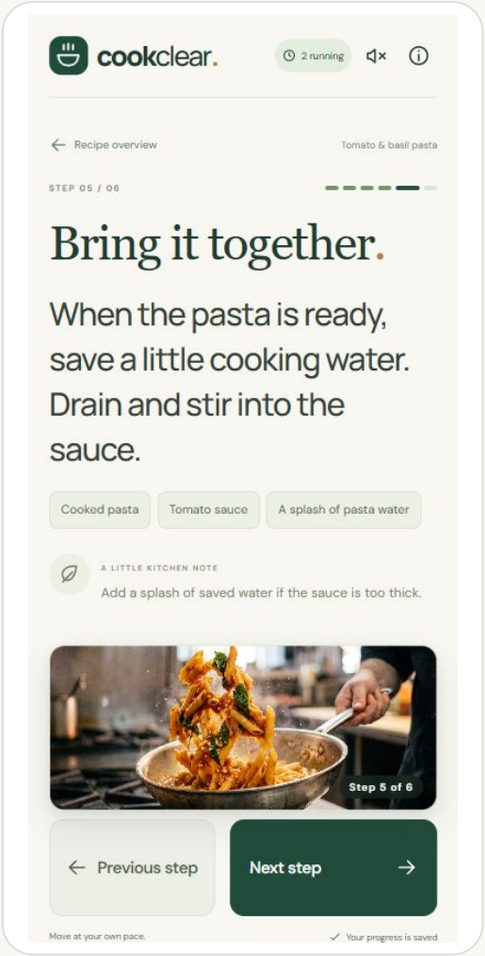
INTERACTION BEHAVIOR

A finished timer stays visible until acknowledged. Acknowledging one task leaves the other task unchanged.

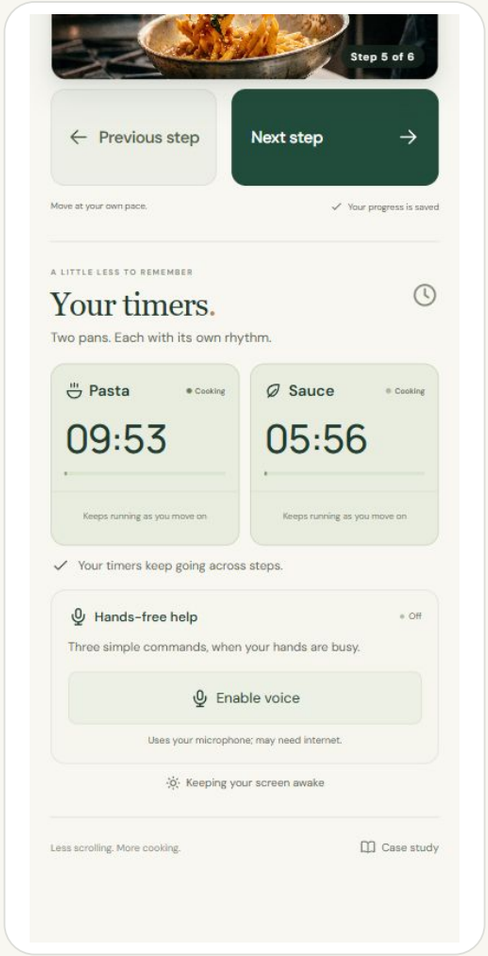
Actual browser prototype capture.
1280 x 800 CSS pixels.
Tablet landscape composition.

05 / Bring it together.

Responsive phone fallback: upper and lower viewport captures of the same vertically scrolling page.



UPPER VIEWPORT / INSTRUCTION



LOWER VIEWPORT / TIMERS

SAME STEP. VERTICAL REFLOW.

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STEP 05 / RECIPE ACTION

When the pasta is ready, save a little cooking water. Drain and stir into the sauce.

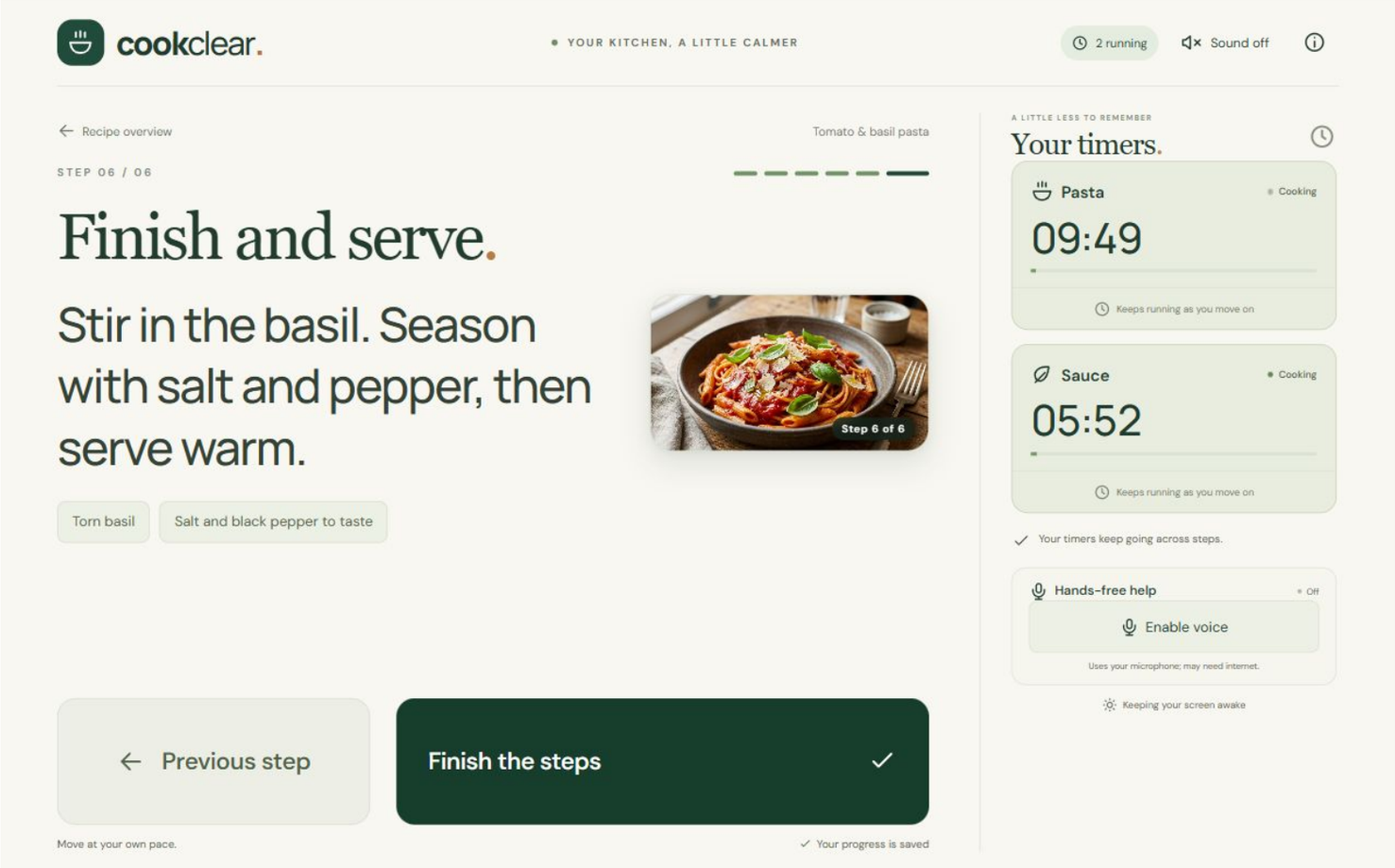
RESPONSIVE CHOICE

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Actual browser prototype capture / 390 x 844 CSS pixels.
The gallery documents layout; it does not claim testing on a physical phone.

06 / Finish and serve.

Primary tablet layout: instruction, supporting image, navigation, and named timers.



NORMAL RECIPE MODE / 10m PASTA + 6m SAUCE

DESIGN DECISION

The final instruction provides a clear finish action. Completion does not erase active or unacknowledged timers.

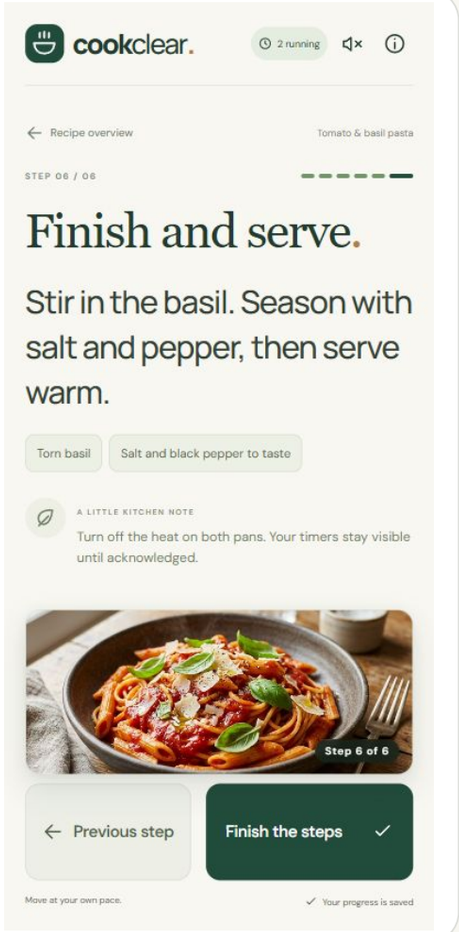
INTERACTION BEHAVIOR

The recipe reminds the cook to turn off both pans. A fresh session uses an explicit reset confirmation.

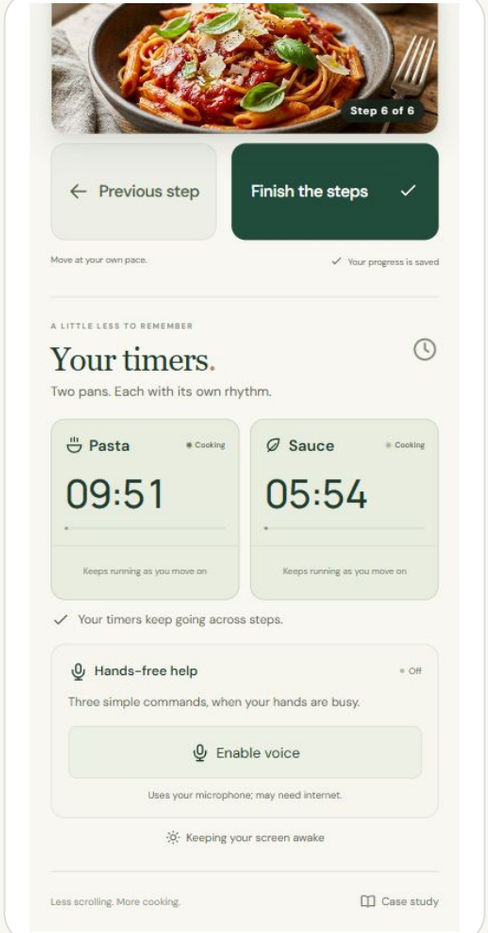
Actual browser prototype capture.
1280 x 800 CSS pixels.
Tablet landscape composition.

06 / Finish and serve.

Responsive phone fallback: upper and lower viewport captures of the same vertically scrolling page.



UPPER VIEWPORT / INSTRUCTION



LOWER VIEWPORT / TIMERS

SAME STEP. VERTICAL REFLOW.

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STEP 06 / RECIPE ACTION

Stir in the basil. Season with salt and pepper, then serve warm.

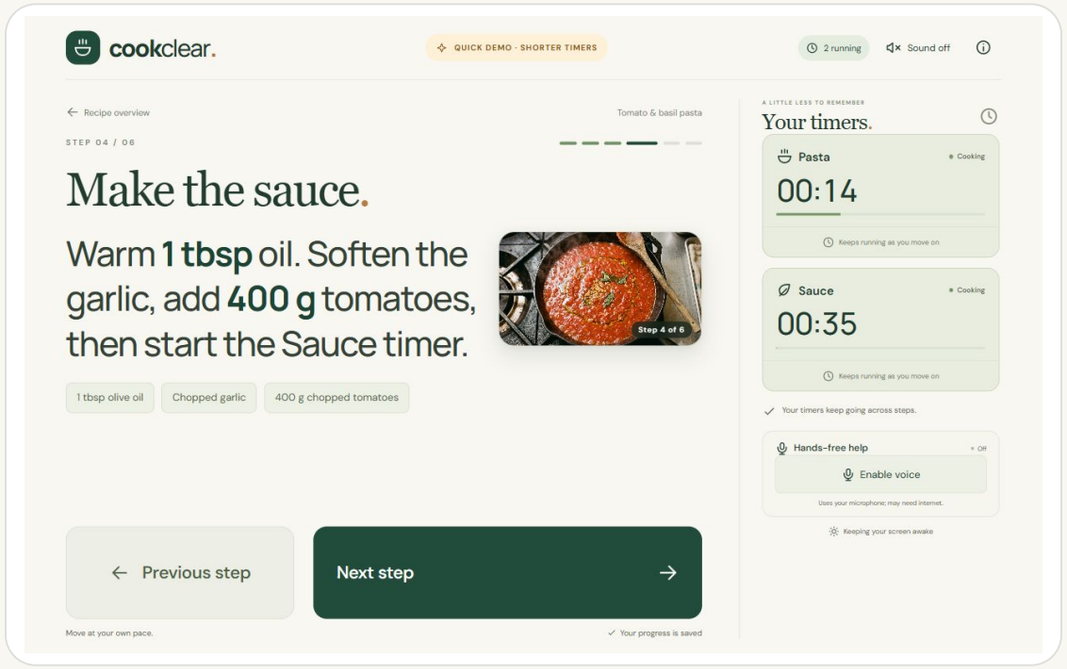
RESPONSIVE CHOICE

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Actual browser prototype capture / 390 x 844 CSS pixels.
The gallery documents layout; it does not claim testing on a physical phone.

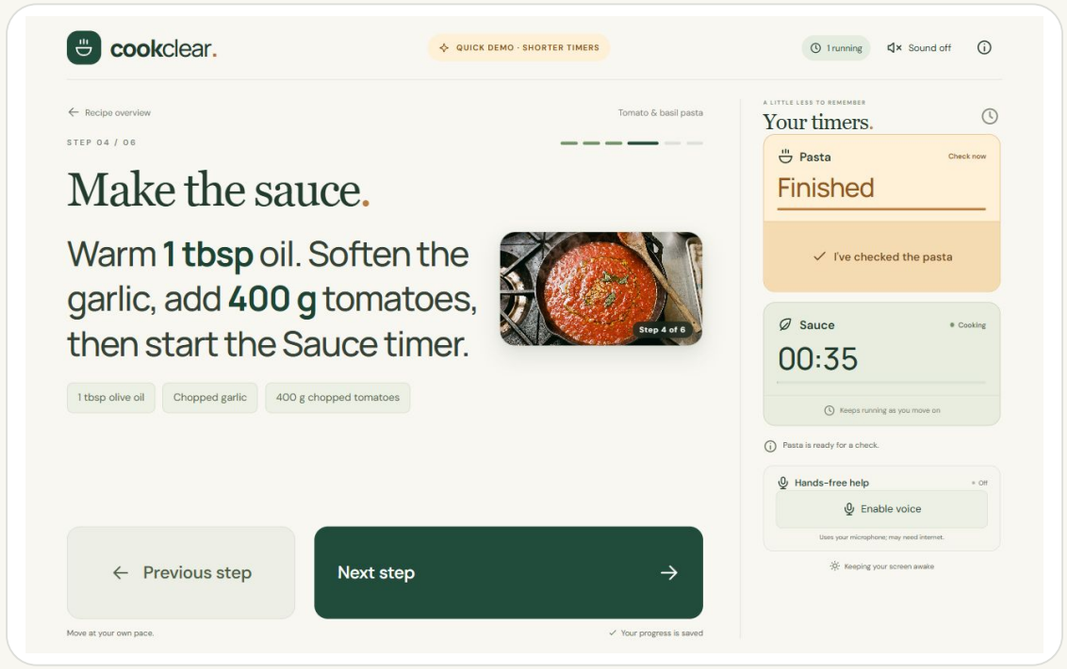
Time continues when attention shifts.

Actual browser captures of the labelled short-timer review demo.



TWO INDEPENDENT DEADLINES

Ready > Running > Finished > Acknowledged. Each task keeps its label and deadline through step changes and refresh. Remaining time is calculated from the current clock.



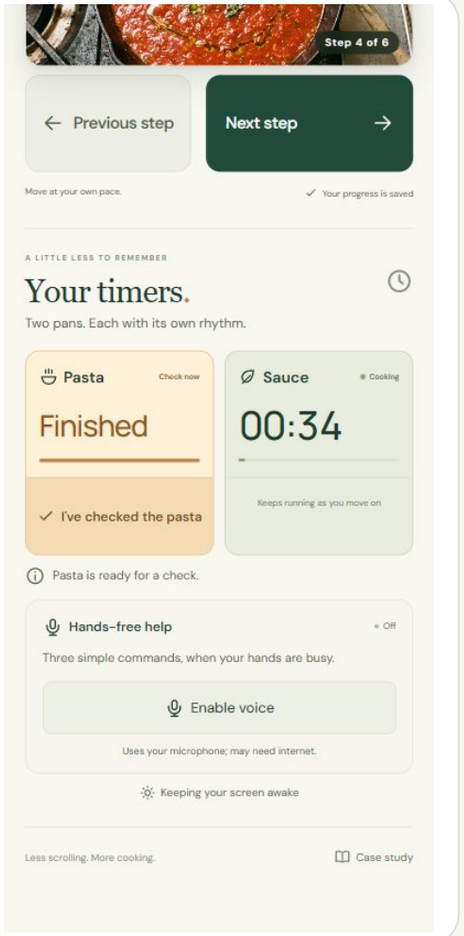
TASK-SPECIFIC FINISHED STATE

A finished task remains visible until acknowledged. Acknowledging Pasta leaves Sauce running. The clearly labelled review demo uses 20s Pasta and 35s Sauce.

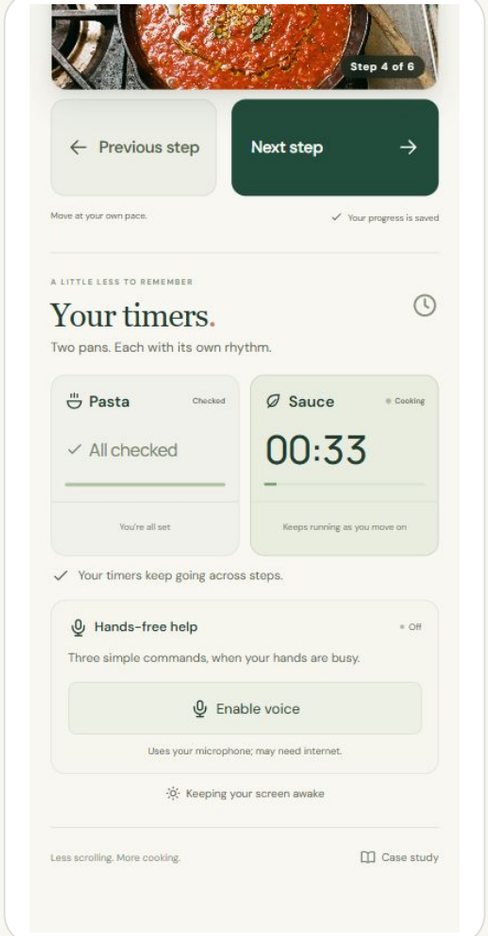
Browser suspension can delay sound; foreground expiry and deadline restoration are the implementation scope.

One acknowledgement. One task changed.

Phone lower-viewport sections and a tablet state show timer identity and isolation in the labelled demo.



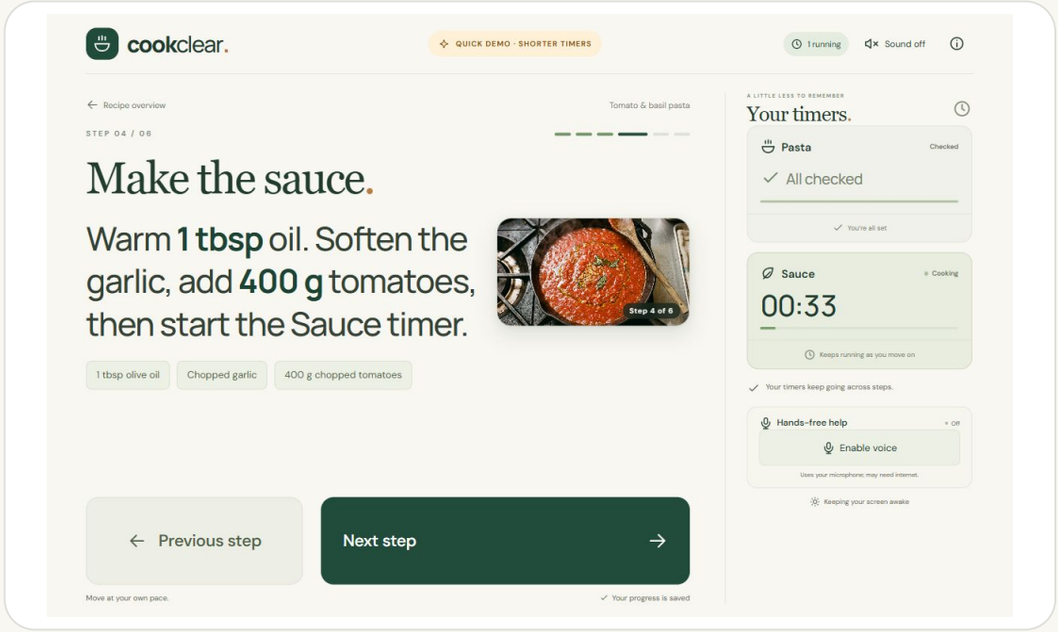
PHONE / FINISHED TASK



PHONE / ACKNOWLEDGED TASK

ACKNOWLEDGE THE NAMED TASK

The finished Pasta timer stays visible until the cook acknowledges it. That action changes Pasta only; a running Sauce timer keeps its original deadline.

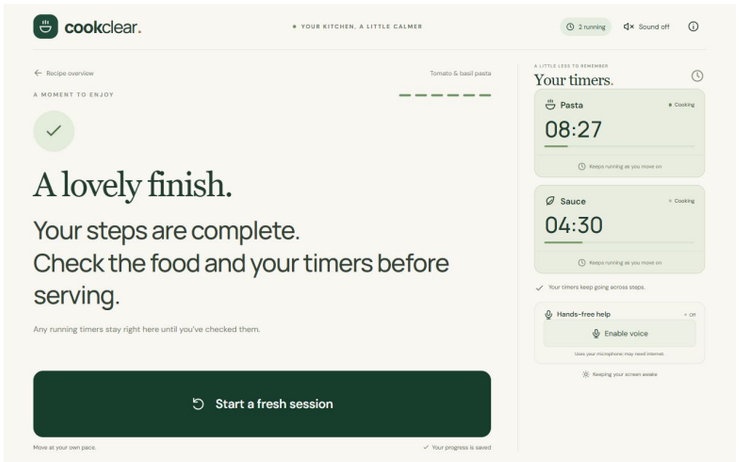


TABLET / ACKNOWLEDGEMENT LEAVES SAUCE RUNNING

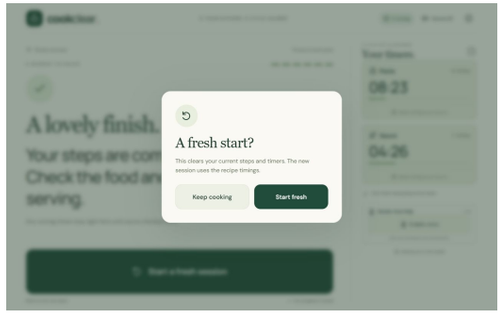
Labelled review demo / 20s Pasta + 35s Sauce.

A clear finish. A deliberate fresh start.

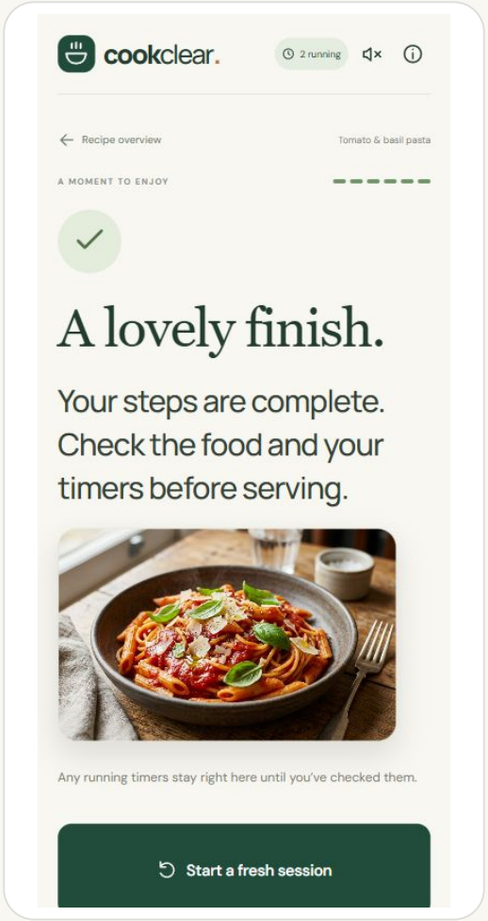
Completion preserves timer state. A new session asks before clearing current cooking progress.



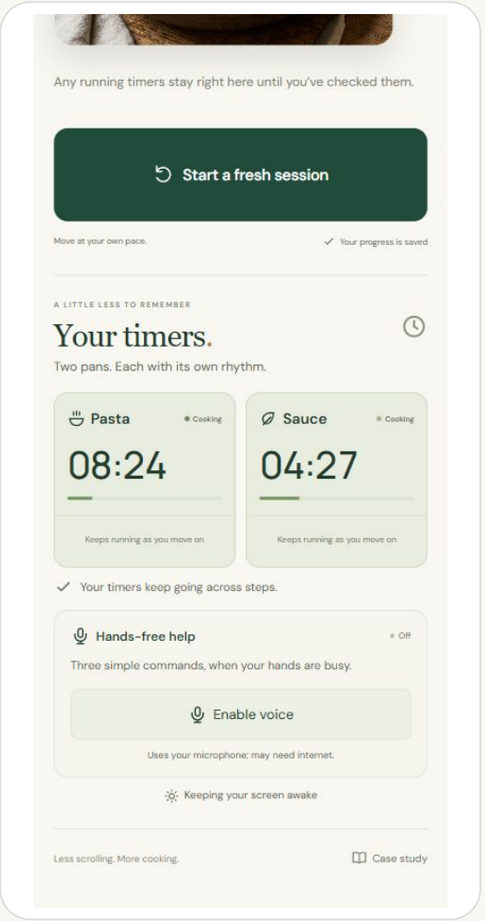
TABLET / COMPLETION KEEPS TIMER STATE



TABLET / EXPLICIT FRESH-SESSION CONFIRMATION



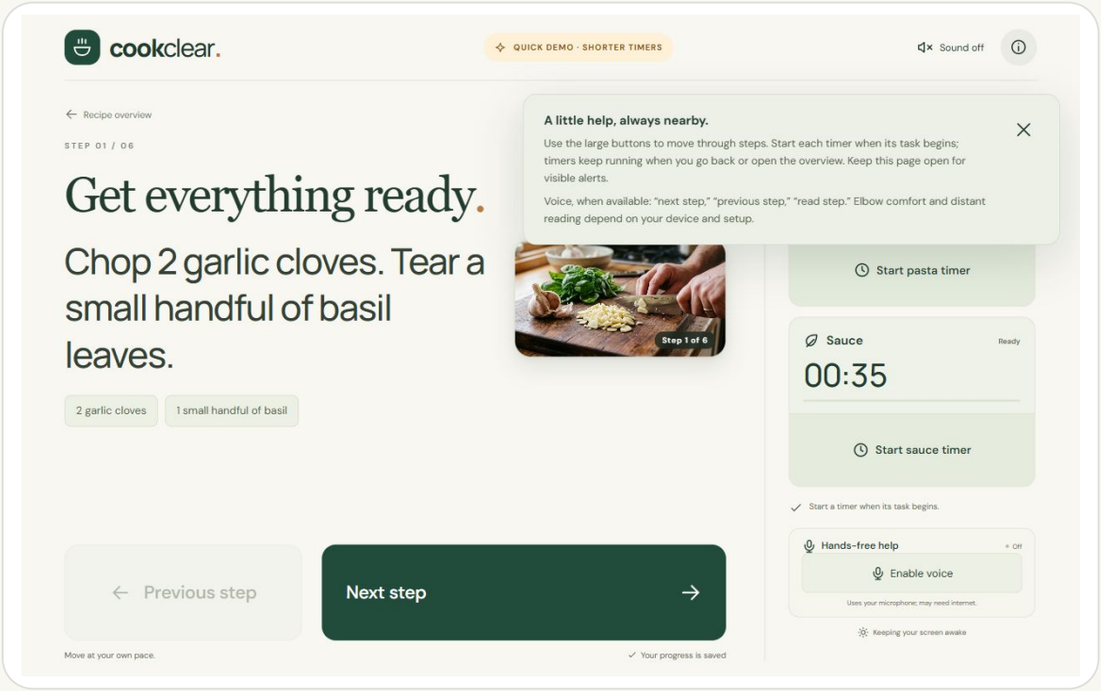
PHONE / UPPER VIEW



PHONE / LOWER VIEW

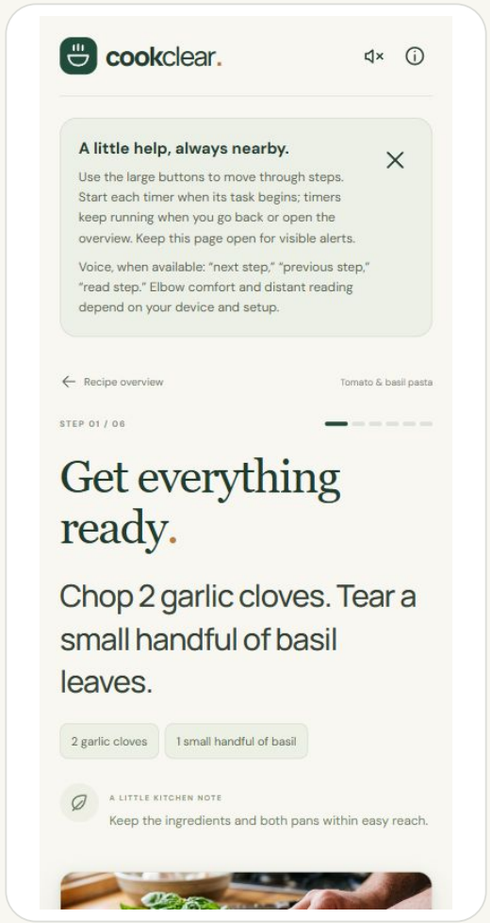
Support stays close to the current task.

Actual browser views of help and deliberate reset. Some screenshots show the labelled 20s / 35s timer demo.

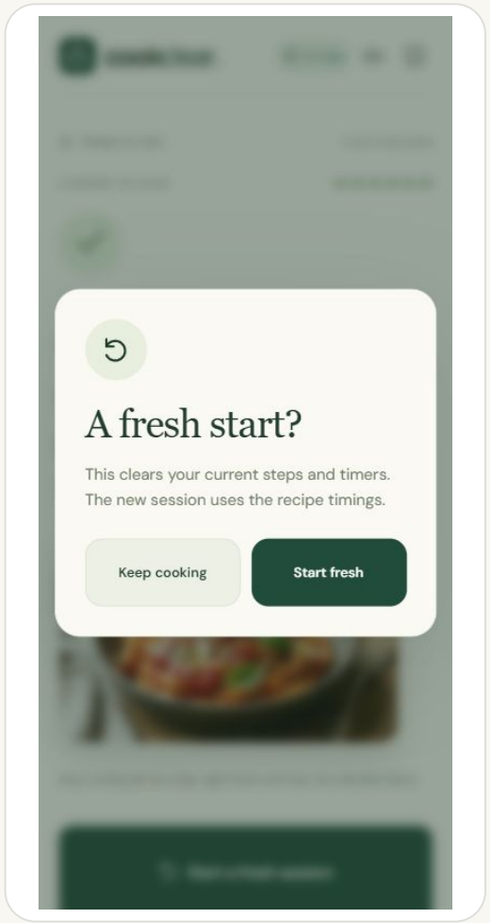


TABLET / HELP WITHIN THE COOKING CONTEXT

Help explains the controls without changing the recipe step. Starting a fresh session asks before clearing saved progress and timers. These views show the labelled timer demo.



PHONE / HELP VIEW



PHONE / RESET CONFIRMATION

Verify the behavior. Label the evidence.

Software and browser checks document implemented behavior; physical human usability remains unvalidated.

IMPLEMENTED BEHAVIOR	RESULT
Two timers keep independent deadlines	PASS
Repeated start cannot reset a timer	PASS
Expiry after a clock jump / late callback	PASS
Acknowledging one leaves the other running	PASS
Step bounds; Back keeps timers running	PASS
Reload restores deadlines; bad data recovers	PASS
Controls on screen, no scroll (7 landscape sizes)	PASS
Spoken voice on the target tablet	LIMITED

Production build passed (Vite 8.3.4). 10 of 10 Node logic tests passed.

Browser checks: Back and refresh preserve progress; acknowledging Pasta leaves Sauce running. All six steps fit seven landscape sizes. Portrait and phone have no horizontal overflow.

BROWSER VIEWPORT EVIDENCE

Seven landscape sizes: 1024 x 570, 1024 x 640, 1280 x 720, 1280 x 800, 1366 x 768, 1440 x 900, and 1920 x 1080. Portrait 800 x 1280 and phone 390 x 844 reflow.

OPTIONAL CAPABILITIES

Voice is feature-detected and opt-in. Spoken commands on the target tablet remain unverified. Wake lock is best-effort. Sound requires user activation and foreground browser support.

EVIDENCE LIMIT

No participant study is included. Physical reading at 3-5 feet, elbow comfort, and task performance remain unvalidated. No improvement percentage, participant quote, or success-rate claim is made.

Screenshots reflect production source (49f1574); hosting overlays are excluded.

Explore the complete cooking flow.

Public prototype, quick timer demo, source code, and primary references.

WORKING PUBLIC PROTOTYPE

Open CookClear

Open the 20s / 35s timer demo

https://cook-clear.netlify.app/

Review the recipe. Start cooking. Start Pasta, then Sauce. Move forward and back. Acknowledge a finished task. Refresh to inspect saved progress and timer restoration.

View the source on GitHub

DELIVERED SCOPE

One complete recipe, six focused steps, recipe overview, two timers, expiry, recovery, completion, deliberate reset, and responsive layouts.

FUTURE DIRECTIONS

More recipes, adjustable text, and device-specific voice and notification support.

PRIMARY SOURCES

The supplied Nielsen assignment defines the constraints. Official guidance and product documentation below informed design and implementation.

W3C

Target Size (Enhanced)

W3C

Pointer Cancellation

CROUTON

Official product documentation

PAPRIKA

Official iOS user guide

MDN

Page Visibility API

Sources reviewed 10 October 2026. Documentation review only; no hands-on competitor evaluation or participant testing is claimed.